

OXYGEN FOR THE SOUL

Yoga has not only helped Swati Bhargava, the Co-founder of CashKaro, become healthier but also a more balanced and empathetic leader

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

For Swati Bhargava, the Co-founder of CashKaro—India's largest cashback and coupons site with over 15 million registered users—her morning yoga ritual is sacrosanct. No matter where she is or how it was the evening before, her day starts with an hour-long yoga session comprising Surya Namaskar, Ashtanga and Hatha yoga poses for a stronger back, and Pranayam. “A lot of people at work often ask me how is it that I am so upbeat every morning. They say, don’t you ever have a bad day? Of course, I do too. But because I have a morning routine and it is so sacrosanct, it really sets me up for the day. I feel as you become a leader, you have to find ways to charge your own batteries, only then can you go around charging others,” says the 39-year-old entrepreneur.

Bhargava, who set up CashKaro along with her husband Rohan in 2013, is an alumnus of the London School of Economics. It was while studying there in 2002 that she was introduced to yoga. She had developed a skin allergy and her mother, who is a trained yoga instructor, asked her to start doing Pranayam. “I started doing Pranayam and I realised that the power of oxygen was so much that when it was going to each of my cells, the allergy basically went away. The belief in me became so strong that no matter what, I will take out time for yoga in the morning,” says Bhargava.

“Unlike going to a gym, I can do yoga anywhere. I don’t need any equipment for



YOGA LOVER Swati Bhargava's hour-long morning yoga session is sacrosanct for her